

Measuring Blood Pressure at Clinic Visits

Example guideline. The text is invented to demonstrate GEM Cutter and is not clinical guidance.

Example Primary Care Network. Released January 2026.

Purpose

This guideline sets out how blood pressure should be measured in adult primary care clinics so that readings are comparable between visits and between clinicians.

Intended users

Medical assistants, nurses and physicians in primary care clinics.

Target population

Adults aged 18 years or older attending a routine clinic visit. Pregnant women are outside the scope of this guideline.

How the guideline was developed

A working group of four clinicians searched for studies published from 2010 to 2025 and graded each recommendation as strong or conditional.

Recommendations

1. Measure blood pressure after the patient has been seated quietly for at least five minutes. (Strong recommendation; moderate-quality evidence)
2. Use a validated automated device with a cuff sized to the upper arm of the patient. (Strong recommendation; high-quality evidence)
3. If the first reading is 140/90 mm Hg or higher, take two further readings one minute apart and record the average of the last two. (Conditional recommendation; low-quality evidence)

Review

This guideline will be reviewed every three years, or sooner if new evidence appears.

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